

Artificial Intelligence and the Job Market: Get Ahead or Fall Behind

As the 2025-2026 school year comes to an end, thousands of upcoming graduates prepare to enter the job market. On paper, the odds of finding employment seem to be improving. Unemployment rates are either dropping or maintaining. The graphs tell a story of hope and improvement, but the rejection letters allude to a much darker reality. The job market today lies in an unprecedented state of uncertainty. Both job seekers and employers are floundering in an ocean of AI, market instability, and an overwhelming number of applications. The disappearance of entry level jobs destabilizes the hierarchical structure of employment as we know it. Additionally, artificial intelligence has completely flipped the traditional job search on its head. Employers and job seekers are turning to AI tools in a desperate attempt to stand out in a market already saturated with AI resumes, cover letters, and hiring managers. Although the numbers tell us unemployment is low, the bleakness and instability of the current job market are the reality we must be able to face. This essay explores the job market, the rise of artificial intelligence, and the relationship between the two. As more graduates prepare to enter the workforce, getting ahead may be the only option, or they risk falling behind permanently.

Section 1: The Job Market

In February of 2026, the US unemployment rate was 4.4%. In March, the rate fell to 4.3%, and has stayed there through the following April.¹ This was expected by the market, and is an impressive improvement from November 2025, where the unemployment rate was 4.5%.² However, the numbers give a misleading understanding of the current job market. To be able to understand how these numbers can be misleading, it is important to understand the definitions the Labor Bureau is using to categorize “employed” and “unemployed”. The civilian labor force, or just labor force, is defined by people who are 16 years or older and fall under the categories of unemployed or employed.³ It includes people who are currently working and looking for work. To be defined as employed, people must meet any of these criteria at the time of the Labor Bureau survey:

¹ *United States Unemployment Rate*, tradingeconomics.com/united-states/unemployment-rate.

² *United States Unemployment Rate*, tradingeconomics.com/united-states/unemployment-rate.

³ “Concepts and Definitions (CPS).” *U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics*, U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, www.bls.gov/cps/definitions.htm#lfconcepts.

1. Worked at least 1 hour as a paid employee
 2. Worked at least 1 hour in their own business, profession, trade, or farm
 3. Were temporarily absent from their job, business, or farm, whether or not they were paid for the time off
 4. Worked without pay for a minimum of 15 hours in a business or farm owned by a member of their family
- ([U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics](#))

If someone meets **all** of the following criteria, they are considered unemployed:

- They were not employed during the survey reference week
- They were available for work during the survey reference week, except for temporary illness
- They made at least one specific, active effort to find a job during the 4-week period ending with the survey reference week

([U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics](#))

If you have not actively searched for a job within 4 weeks of the survey reference week, you are no longer considered unemployed and therefore are not a part of the labor force. This is an extremely important detail to understand when deciphering graphs related to the unemployment rate. Although the unemployment rate has lowered, the labor force shrank by 92,000.⁴ If people are no longer looking for work, they are no longer considered part of the labor force. This technically drives the unemployment rate down, since less people are now considered unemployed, yet the job market is not improving. People who are still actively searching for employment are not getting more jobs; they are just fighting for fewer opportunities. However, the population of the labor force is also important to remember. The aging population is driving down labor force participation as the job market continues to shrink. The declining birth rate around the world means that the upcoming generation is smaller than their predecessors, which naturally would mean the labor force is shrinking. The Federal Reserve Board estimates that the potential labor supply will be stagnant in 2026.⁵ If there are fewer workers, there is less of a need for jobs to be created, further increasing the competition between job seekers.

As the labor force continues to shrink, desperation amongst job seekers continues to grow. In March of 2026, 178,000 people were added to the definition of employment, following a 133,000-person drop in February and a 166,000-person jump in January.⁶ This whiplash effect is creating mass uncertainty and inciting panic among job seekers and employers alike. As jobs are unpredictably added and removed, the unemployed grow restless. They begin mass-applying to positions regardless of their experience level or qualifications. Long-term unemployment is associated with broader social ramifications, such as high stress levels, health problems, family

⁴ *United States Unemployment Rate*, tradingeconomics.com/united-states/unemployment-rate.

⁵ Sahm, Claudia. "US Economy Faces Whiplash as Supply Shocks Distort Jobs and Inflation." *Investing.Com*, Investing.com, 17 Apr. 2026, www.investing.com/analysis/us-economy-faces-whiplash-as-supply-shocks-distort-jobs-and-inflation-200678716.

⁶ Sahm, Claudia. "US Economy Faces Whiplash as Supply Shocks Distort Jobs and Inflation." *Investing.Com*, Investing.com, 17 Apr. 2026, www.investing.com/analysis/us-economy-faces-whiplash-as-supply-shocks-distort-jobs-and-inflation-200678716.

dysfunction, and higher rates of anxiety, depression, and suicide.⁷ Many recent graduates are struggling to find jobs due to the disappearance of entry level positions. Between January of 2023 and August of 2025, entry level job postings declined 35%, with roles that are easily automated facing an even more severe impact.⁸ Entry level positions are essential for the career ladder. New graduates will not be able to gain the necessary experience for high paying positions and will either remain unemployed or struggle immensely with tasks they were not prepared for. The automation of entry level positions may save money in the short term, but it is creating a talent crisis that will only continue to deteriorate employment.

Alongside job-seeker anxiety, employers have responded with their own form of volatility to the whiplash effect of the job market. Major companies that are leaders of the technology fields have announced mass-layoffs in the last year. Companies like Meta, Intel, and Cisco announced cutting over 130,000 jobs in 2025.⁹ Microsoft and Oracle are offering buyouts to high-cost employees in order to mitigate for heavy AI spending. Big tech companies are moving away from having large, expensive workforces in favor of smaller, more cost-effective teams that are automated. Not only are graduates at risk of never finding employment, but so are candidates that are highly skilled and have relevant experience in the field. Mass-layoffs, a shrinking labor force, and the disappearance of entry level positions are indicative of a larger problem. That problem may stem from the introduction of artificial intelligence into the workforce.

Section Two: Artificial Intelligence

Though the term “artificial intelligence” was only coined in 1955¹⁰, the concept of a highly intelligent machine has been around for far longer than many people think. In 1726, Jonathan Swift introduced the idea of The Engine in his novel “Gulliver’s Travels”.¹¹ The Engine can generate ideas and sentences for books and is one of the first references to a device like generative AI. Humans have been envisioning a machine that is capable of independent thought for hundreds of years and were able to make tangible progress within the last century. A landmark invention in computing was the ABC computer. Created in 1939, the ABC computer used binary instead of decimal systems and was also one of the first computers to use electronic circuits for computation, allowing for faster and more reliable calculations. It separated memory

⁷ “Long-Term Unemployment: Economics: Research Starters: EBSCO Research.” *EBSCO*, 2021, www.ebsco.com/research-starters/economics/long-term-unemployment.

⁸ Sandoval, Fabian. “If Entry-Level Jobs Are Vanishing, Where Will the Future Executives Come From?” *Ivy Exec*, 12 Aug. 2025, ivyexec.com/career-advice/2025/if-entry-level-jobs-are-vanishing-where-will-the-future-executives-come-from.

⁹ Sandoval, Fabian. “If Entry-Level Jobs Are Vanishing, Where Will the Future Executives Come From?” *Ivy Exec*, 12 Aug. 2025, ivyexec.com/career-advice/2025/if-entry-level-jobs-are-vanishing-where-will-the-future-executives-come-from.

¹⁰ Mucci, Tim. “The History of Artificial Intelligence.” *IBM*, 17 Nov. 2025, www.ibm.com/think/topics/history-of-artificial-intelligence.

¹¹ Mucci, Tim. “The History of Artificial Intelligence.” *IBM*, 17 Nov. 2025, www.ibm.com/think/topics/history-of-artificial-intelligence.

from the processing unit, a process that is still followed today.¹² Although the ABC computer was never fully operational, it revolutionized modern computing and paved the way for artificial intelligence as we know it. In 1950, Alan Turing's paper "Computing Machinery and Intelligence" was published, marking the beginning of the question "Can machines think?"¹³ This paper has since become a historical text in the foundation of AI, and began a central method of measuring machine intelligence by its ability to mimic human conversation and behavior.

Moving into a more modern era, artificial intelligence has exploded in both ingenuity and public popularity. Beginning in 2000, AI algorithms can complete large scale pattern recognition. They were used for facial recognition, trained on massive neural networks of images, and were able to give individualized responses, such as Apple's Siri. In 2016, Google's AlphaGo defeated one of the world's top Go players, Lee Sedol. The game of Go has more possible moves than atoms in the universe and was often an immense challenge for AI bots. This groundbreaking success proved that AI was now able to comprehend highly complex strategic tasks.¹⁴ In 2017, researchers at Facebook Artificial Intelligence Research began an experiment with two chatbots that were trained to negotiate with each other in English. These bots diverged from the traditional human language to communicate more efficiently and they were promptly shut down in order to keep the bots within human understanding.¹⁵ This experiment was an early indication that AI learning models were able to develop autonomously and unpredictably.

Over the last 6 years, AI has become the formidable force that we think of today. OpenAI introduced GPT-3 in 2020, the largest and most sophisticated AI model of its time. It was a language model with 175 billion parameters capable of almost perfectly mimicking human text and conversation, alongside coding, translating, and creative content.¹⁶ This model was one of the earliest examples of a large language model that could understand and produce highly coherent language with very little specific training. The release of GPT-3 marks a turning point in world history. 76 years ago, Alan Turing posed the question: Can machines think? Back then, that question was far from answerable, and the technology needed to even begin considering that idea was yet to be invented. But in 2020, the answer to that question became a very real debate as we continue to interact with an intelligence that only improves with every conversation.

With the release of large-scale language models like ChatGPT, Claude Sonnet, and Gemini, the companies creating these bots have seen a dramatic increase in the infrastructure needed to maintain them. AI data centers have begun to pop up around the globe. They house specific technology needed to train and deliver AI services.¹⁷ AI data centers function much the

¹² Mucci, Tim. "The History of Artificial Intelligence." *IBM*, 17 Nov. 2025, www.ibm.com/think/topics/history-of-artificial-intelligence.

¹³ Mucci, Tim. "The History of Artificial Intelligence." *IBM*, 17 Nov. 2025, www.ibm.com/think/topics/history-of-artificial-intelligence.

¹⁴ Mucci, Tim. "The History of Artificial Intelligence." *IBM*, 17 Nov. 2025, www.ibm.com/think/topics/history-of-artificial-intelligence.

¹⁵ Mucci, Tim. "The History of Artificial Intelligence." *IBM*, 17 Nov. 2025, www.ibm.com/think/topics/history-of-artificial-intelligence.

¹⁶ Mucci, Tim. "The History of Artificial Intelligence." *IBM*, 17 Nov. 2025, www.ibm.com/think/topics/history-of-artificial-intelligence.

¹⁷ Jonker, Alexandra, and Alice Gomstyn. "What Is an AI Data Center?" *IBM*, 17 Nov. 2025, www.ibm.com/think/topics/ai-data-center.

same as traditional data centers: they both contain servers, storage systems, and networking equipment. However, AI data centers demand an extraordinary amount of high-intensity workloads. They are designed for AI and machine learning tasks that would overwhelm the hardware of standard data centers.¹⁸ Companies that are developing generative AI, like Amazon, Microsoft, and Google, often use a hyperscale data center. Hyperscale data centers are massive, taking up at least 10,000 square feet of physical space and housing at least 5,000 servers. These are used for high-performance computing that is necessary for machine and deep learning models, natural language processing, and other AI operations. They can support massive bandwidth requirements to provide split-second decisions and responses to users, often ranging from gigabits per second to terabits per second.¹⁹

AI itself is a powerful and extremely useful technology, especially when used in medical or software fields. It has been hailed as the electricity of the modern age and will only continue to infiltrate every aspect of our lives. Since AI requires an extreme amount of computing power, it also requires an extreme amount of electricity and cooling. Thousands of graphic processing units must run continuously for months, leading to high electricity consumption that strains power grids.²⁰ The growing complexity of large language models only leads to more infrastructure failures and software issues, forcing the model to use even more electricity. Not only do data centers use mass amounts of electricity, but they also need enormous amounts of water for their cooling systems. The servers within data centers use electrical energy to perform calculations and store data, producing heat as they lose some electrical energy. The heat must be removed from the server to prevent damage and overheating, which has typically been dealt with using fans and air-cooling systems.²¹ As data centers grow in capacity, water evaporation cooling has taken precedence as it is more energy-efficient and can handle higher outputs of heat. However, this uses up a significant amount of water as it evaporates the waste energy heat. The water often is purchased from local water utilities and comes from surface or ground water. In the U.S., data centers have used about 800 billion liters of water.²² Although some data centers have begun shifting away from a water-cooling system and towards immersion liquid cooling, data centers that are in areas already scarce of water are placing high strains on local resources. Water costs are driven up by lack of resources, forcing the local population to pay the price of high computational power that has taken residence in their town.²³

¹⁸ Jonker, Alexandra, and Alice Gomstyn. "What Is an AI Data Center?" *IBM*, 17 Nov. 2025, www.ibm.com/think/topics/ai-data-center.

¹⁹ Jonker, Alexandra, and Alice Gomstyn. "What Is an AI Data Center?" *IBM*, 17 Nov. 2025, www.ibm.com/think/topics/ai-data-center.

²⁰ Kandemir, Mahmut. "Why AI Uses so Much Energy - and What We Can Do about It." *Institute of Energy and the Environment*, 8 Apr. 2025, ice.psu.edu/news/blog/why-ai-uses-so-much-energy-and-what-we-can-do-about-it.

²¹ Pusic, Mara. "AI's Cooling Problem: How Data Centers Are Transforming Water Use." *Environmental Law Institute*, 23 Oct. 2025, www.eli.org/vibrant-environment-blog/ais-cooling-problem-how-data-centers-are-transforming-water-use.

²² Pusic, Mara. "AI's Cooling Problem: How Data Centers Are Transforming Water Use." *Environmental Law Institute*, 23 Oct. 2025, www.eli.org/vibrant-environment-blog/ais-cooling-problem-how-data-centers-are-transforming-water-use.

²³ Pusic, Mara. "AI's Cooling Problem: How Data Centers Are Transforming Water Use." *Environmental Law Institute*, 23 Oct. 2025, www.eli.org/vibrant-environment-blog/ais-cooling-problem-how-data-centers-are-transforming-water-use.

The growth of AI language models and their data centers have presented both incredible opportunity and immense challenges. While AI could empower companies to make working life significantly more efficient and take the pressure of high workloads, it also poses a threat to thousands of jobs. While the AI may not be capable of replacing the output of a human employee, its financial importance will take precedence. Oracle has announced it is laying off thousands of employees, not to replace them, but to divert their salaries to AI investments and maintaining data centers.²⁴ The demand for AI is outpacing our understanding of its consequences, and we are beginning to see the ramifications of this as AI infiltrates the job market.

Section Three: AI in the Recruitment Process

As expensive data centers divert funds away from the workforce, job seekers find themselves floundering in an artificially generated world. Applications begin pouring in, hundreds more than ever before. Employers have found themselves in an interesting predicament: they are relying on yet also hiring the consequences of their own actions. Due to the high volume of applications, many companies are now using AI resume screening. AI recruitment agencies use machine learning to identify high-quality candidates in a fraction of the time it would take a human hiring manager. Indeed's Talent Scout works like standard Indeed, but for employers. The company gives Talent Scout a list of parameters that the job posting requires, secures a list of people that fit those parameters, and can even reach out to those candidates with personalized messages.²⁵ The biggest benefit to using an AI hiring manager is efficiency. It can produce a highly specialized list that expedites the scouting process, allowing hiring managers to interview only highly qualified candidates much faster. Furthermore, the algorithm is constantly updating and improving, meaning the candidate pool is never solidified and will continue to produce high-quality applicants.²⁶

However, where a human could extrapolate from a resume, the AI is unable to look past its own criteria. 88% of employers agree that AI hiring processes can disqualify qualified candidates based on the lack of specific keywords in a resume. These potential hires may have made it to an interview if the hiring manager was able to recognize their qualifications, but since the AI does not detect a specific field or skill, those candidates were eliminated from consideration.²⁷ It is important for employers to work with their AI hiring tools, not for them. They can make the hiring process significantly more efficient, but resumes should still be carefully reviewed by human hiring managers. Additionally, the AI is only looking for key words and cannot detect the nuances of the words around it. For example, any candidate can put the words "Microsoft" or "Engineer" in their resume to be picked up by the AI. A human being

²⁴ Mody, Seema, and Jordan Novet. "Oracle Cutting Thousands in Latest Layoff Round as Company Continues to Ramp AI Spending." *CNBC*, CNBC, 31 Mar. 2026, www.cnbc.com/2026/03/31/oracle-layoffs-ai-spending.html.

²⁵ "Talent Scout | AI Recruitment Software from Indeed." *Indeed*, www.indeed.com/employers/talentscout.

²⁶ "The Evolving Role of AI in Recruitment and Retention." *SHRM Labs*, www.shrm.org/labs/resources/the-evolving-role-of-ai-in-recruitment-and-retention.

²⁷ Elting, Liz. "AI Hiring Tools May Overlook Top Talent-Here's What Leaders Can Do about It." *Forbes*, Forbes Magazine, 30 July 2025, www.forbes.com/sites/lizelting/2025/07/30/ai-hiring-tools-overlook-top-talent-heres-what-leaders-can-do-about-it/.

may be able to tell that the resume doesn't seem to be truthful, but since the AI only sees keywords, that candidate may be selected over someone who is actually qualified. Another example of AI overlooking nuance lies in the resume of "Angelina Lee". This fictitious candidate submitted resumes to software engineering job postings and initially received little to no responses from jobs. The resume was then tailored to include experience from big tech companies like Meta and Zillow, alongside special skills such as "Spread herpes STD to 60% of intern team" and "Fraternity record for most vodka shots in one night".²⁸ There was a 10 times increase in the number of responses after the buzz words were added into the resume despite the outrageous skills listed beneath them. The AI hiring manager does not scan the text in a way that would alert it to clearly false or fabricated information, rather it prioritizes very select key words and chooses candidates on those words alone.

While employers lean on AI to manage the influx of applications, candidates have responded in kind. Job postings are used as references for AI chatbots to tailor candidate resumes for the listings. This homogenizes the hiring pool, flooding employers with hundreds of nearly identical resumes and cover letters. Personality and originality are dropped to prioritize appeasing the AI hiring manager, which doesn't care for the person behind the resume. It only cares whether the words on the page match its parameters.

The Experiment

To stand out amongst a sea of meticulously curated applicants, it is essential that you know what the AI is looking for. To investigate this further, I designed an experiment comparing how 3 large language models approach resume tailoring for the same job posting. I will be using the AI chatbots I have had the most experience with and the ones I believe are most used for resume tailoring: ChatGPT, Gemini, and Claude. I will be giving each AI my own [resume](#), a link to the same job posting, and the same prompt:

Can you tailor my resume to this job posting? Can you include a detailed explanation of what you changed, and why?

The job posting is for a technical writer position, a career field I will be applying to after graduation. The chosen prompt will allow me to see what specific terminology was changed, altered, and kept, and the reasoning behind it. The results will be compared against each other.

²⁸ "Recruitment Is Broken, What Are Businesses Doing to Fix It?" *Financial Times*, Youtube, 7 Oct. 2024, www.youtube.com/watch?v=FrQFFH2V8g0.

About the job

We are looking for an experienced Technical Writer to support the Army Logistics Research and Engineering Directorate. This individual will be responsible for creating, editing, and managing a variety of technical documents and publications. The ideal candidate will possess strong technical writing skills, a keen attention to detail, and the ability to work closely with subject matter experts to ensure clarity and accuracy in all materials.

Key Responsibilities

- Develop and maintain high-quality technical documentation in XML.
- Collaborate with technical subject matter experts to gather information and ensure content accuracy.
- Edit and proofread documents for clarity, consistency, and adherence to publication standards.
- Ensure all documentation meets company and industry standards.

Job Requirements

- BA/BS degree in Technical Writing, English, Communication, or a related field with three (3) years of relevant experience; or a high school diploma/equivalent with five (5) years of highly relevant specialized experience, including prolonged military instruction.
- Demonstrated experience in technical writing functions, publication standards, and processes.
- Preferred experience with XMetaL, Arbortext, FrameMaker, MadCap Flare, or equivalent software tool.
- Proficient in Microsoft Office applications, particularly Word and Excel.
- Strong organizational skills and the ability to manage multiple projects simultaneously.
- Excellent communication skills, both written and verbal.
- Must be a U.S. Citizen.

Figure 1: The job posting presented to each AI. Click the image to view on LinkedIn.

ChatGPT:

- Suggestion 1: Add a Targeted Professional Summary
 - Addition: Detail-oriented technical writing and communications student with experience creating software manuals, technical documentation, and user-focused content through coursework and certification programs. Skilled in editing, publication standards, accessible design, and collaboration with teams. Proficient in MadCap Flare, Microsoft Office, HTML/CSS, and technical communication practices.
 - Why: Your current resume jumps straight into education. Since you are early-career, a summary helps recruiters immediately connect your background to technical writing and documentation.
- Suggestion 2: Reorganize Your Skills Section
 - This directly aligns your resume with the posting's language and makes scanning easier for recruiters.
- Suggestion 3: Strengthen the Coursework Section
 - Revision: Developed technical documentation including software manuals, instructional materials, and a MadCap Flare documentation project // Applied publication standards, accessibility principles, and user-focused writing strategies // Edited and revised documents for clarity, consistency, and usability // Practiced writing in corporate, technical, and digital communication formats
 - Why: This reframes your coursework as practical technical writing experience rather than just classes.

- Suggestion 4: Emphasize Documentation & Organizational Experience in Leadership Roles
 - Revision: Managed financial records, budgeting documentation, and organizational communications for a collegiate athletic team // Coordinated travel planning, schedules, and logistical documentation for team events
 - Why: The employer wants organization and documentation skills. These revisions highlight those strengths.
- Suggestion 5: Improve IT Ambassador Position for Communication Focus
 - Revision: Communicate campus IT resources and technical information through events, presentations, and social media outreach // Support clear and accessible communication between IT services and students // Collaborate with teams to promote technology initiatives and user engagement
 - Why: This shows communication skills, technical communication, and collaboration with stakeholders -all major requirements for the role.
- Suggestion 6: Add Microsoft Office More Prominently
 - Recruiters often scan for exact software matches.
- Suggestion 7: Add XML Exposure Carefully
 - Suggested Addition: Familiar with structured documentation environments through MadCap Flare coursework
 - Why: This subtly bridges toward XML-based systems without overstating experience.
- Suggestion 8: Slightly Reduce Less-Relevant Content
 - Why: Keeps the honor while making room for more job-relevant material.

Gemini:

- Suggestion 1: Placed "U.S. Citizen" right below your contact information.
 - Why: The job description explicitly states "**Must be a U.S. Citizen**" as a mandatory hiring requirement. Putting this at the very top immediately checks that compliance box for government/defense contracting recruiters who filter resumes based on citizenship status.
- Suggestion 2: Elevated your coursework section into a robust, accomplishment-driven "Technical Writing & IT Projects" section right after your education.
 - The job requires experience with technical writing functions and publication standards. Because you are finishing your degree, framing your rigorous **PWTC certification** projects (like the MadCap Flare project and software manual) as hands-on technical achievements showcases your practical capability to manage documentation pipelines.
- Suggestion 3: Highlighted **MadCap Flare** prominently in your project bullets and placed it at the beginning of your Technical Skills list.

- The job posting lists "*Preferred experience with XMetaL, Arbortext, FrameMaker, MadCap Flare, or equivalent software tool.*" You have a direct, 1-to-1 match for a preferred tool. Making this keyword unmistakable helps you pass automated Applicant Tracking Systems (ATS) and catches the hiring manager's eye.
- Suggestion 4: Used active verbs that mimic the job description's "Key Responsibilities" (e.g., *collaborated, communicated technical information, compiled, managed project logistics*).
 - The job values collaborating with subject matter experts, proofreading for clarity, and managing multiple projects.
 - Your **IT Student Ambassador** role was framed to highlight working alongside IT professionals to deliver information.
 - Your **Treasurer** role was framed to emphasize your capability to manage multiple operational projects and logistics simultaneously.
- Suggestion 5: Divided your skills into clear, scannable subcategories: *Technical Software & Tools, Technical Writing & Editing, and Professional Competencies*.
 - The job requires high proficiency in Microsoft Word/Excel and editing to publication standards. Categorizing your skills allows a recruiter to instantly verify that you possess the exact blending of software familiarity and writing/editing methodology they need.

Claude:

- Suggestion 1: Technical Skills Section
 - Changed to: MadCap Flare, XML Authoring, Microsoft Office (Word, Excel), HTML, CSS, Adobe Illustrator, Python, Java, Google Tools, AI Tools
 - Why: The job explicitly calls out MadCap Flare and proficiency in Word/Excel by name — so those were moved to the front. XML was added because the very first key responsibility is developing documentation in XML, and you have relevant training with XML-based tools. "Social Media" was removed since it's not relevant to this role.
- Suggestion 2: Professional Skills Section
 - Changed to: Technical Writing, Documentation Development, Publication Standards, Editing & Proofreading, Subject Matter Expert Collaboration, Research & Analysis, Critical Thinking
 - Why: "Publication standards" and "subject matter expert collaboration" are pulled directly from the job description's key responsibilities. "Documentation Development" more precisely matches the job language than just "Editing." These keywords also help with any automated applicant screening.
- Suggestion 3: Relevant Coursework – MadCap Flare Bullet

- Changed to: Developed a software manual, technical grant proposal, and XML-based MadCap Flare documentation project adhering to professional publication standards
- This reframe uses action verbs, ties the MadCap Flare work explicitly to XML (the job's primary technical requirement), and echoes "publication standards" from the job posting.
- Suggestion 4: Relevant Coursework – Writing Styles Bullet
 - Changed to: Trained in multiple technical writing styles, including corporate documentation, user manuals, and instructional content for diverse audiences
 - Why: "Blog" isn't relevant here; "user manuals" and "instructional content" are far more aligned with Army logistics technical documentation. "Diverse audiences" also speaks to the clarity/accessibility requirement.
- Suggestion 4: Relevant Coursework – Accessible Design Bullet
 - Changed to: Applied accessible, user-oriented design principles to ensure clarity, consistency, and accuracy across all documentation
 - Why: "Clarity, consistency, and accuracy" are the exact three qualities listed in the job's editing responsibility. This makes the connection explicit for the hiring manager.
- Suggestion 5: IT Ambassador Bullet
 - Changed to: Communicate technical information clearly to non-technical audiences through written materials, campus events, and social media; collaborate with IT staff to ensure content accuracy
 - Why: This reframe highlights two core job competencies — translating technical information for general audiences, and collaborating with subject matter experts to ensure accuracy — both of which are directly named in the job posting.
- Suggestion 6: Sportime – bullet 1
 - Changed to: Managed multiple concurrent responsibilities — supervising 2–4 counselors, coordinating schedules, and maintaining program documentation in a fast-paced environment
 - Why: The job requires managing multiple projects simultaneously. This reframe surfaces that skill, and the addition of "program documentation" is a reasonable reflection of what a Head Counselor does and draws a line to documentation management.
- Suggestion 7: Sportime – bullet 2
 - Changed to: Produced written communications and reports for administrators and parents, ensuring clarity, safety compliance, and consistent messaging
 - Why: "Facilitated communication" is vague. "Produced written communications and reports" positions you as someone with demonstrated written output — directly applicable to a technical writing role. "Clarity" and "consistent messaging" again echo the job's language.

Each AI produced a list of suggestions with clear reasonings as to why they changed what they did. First, looking at similarities, every AI was highly responsive to key words. Claude says, “These keywords also help with any automated applicant screening.” Gemini says, “Making this keyword unmistakable helps you pass automated Applicant Tracking Systems (ATS) and catches the hiring manager's eye.” ChatGPT says, “This directly aligns your resume with the posting’s language and makes scanning easier for recruiters.” They are using keywords as the foundation upon which they built my entire resume. Every AI identified MadCap Flare as a perfect match to the job description and made it the most prominent technical skill in my resume alongside XML authoring. Every AI also suggested reframing the IT student ambassador section to emphasize communication and translating technical skills to audiences. All 3 highly emphasized technical skills that are specifically mentioned in the job description over previous experience. They often use the same words multiple times. For example, Claude suggests using “Publication Standards” and “Documentation Development” in two different sections because those words are used in the job description, despite neither “publishing” nor “publication” appearing anywhere on my resume originally. Similarly, ChatGPT suggested adding “Publication Standards” to my coursework section simply because it is used in the job description. Overall, every AI recommended similar suggestions; emphasizing technical skills, using exact keywords, and reframing experiences to exactly match the job description.

However, each AI has its own unique method of the suggesting improvements. For example, Gemini identified the fact that the applicant must be a U.S. Citizen. It made that a prominent part of the resume and was the first thing it suggested. Neither Claude nor ChatGPT mentioned this caveat at all. Gemini clearly prioritizes meeting very exact criteria and making those criteria extremely noticeable to AI screeners. ChatGPT gave the vaguest feedback, often just saying to “improve” sections and offering the least amount of reasoning behind its decisions. However, ChatGPT is the only AI to outright say, “You should NOT claim XML experience if you don’t have it.” Claude directly included XML authoring as a skill, without emphasizing that it should not be included if I do not actually have XML experience. ChatGPT changed the least amount of the three AI’s but was the most careful about maintaining genuine skill. Claude was the only AI that had any suggestions about my work experience, despite it being irrelevant to the position. ChatGPT and Gemini skipped the Sportime Summer Camp section entirely, focusing only on improving relevant experience and technical skills. This may be beneficial for passing the AI hiring tool, but a human hiring manager will most likely see that section and give it more depth than the AI would. Not only does it improve the Sportime section, but it also tailors it to the job description. It frames the skills used as a Head Counselor as similar to a technical writer managing multiple teams at the same time. Claude is the only AI that improved the entire resume, not just select sections that were already relevant to the job description. For job seekers, this could be the difference between getting eliminated and getting hired. It suggests that Claude may be the most useful tool in terms of resume tailoring, and that Claude is the most well-rounded AI of the three tested. It uses every section available, regardless of its prior relevancy.

This experiment set out to explore three different large language models, and how they can be used by job seekers in the hiring process. Overall, I have found that they are extremely similar. Although each AI had its own unique suggestions, and at some points prioritized different material, all three used direct keywords from the job description in almost the exact same manner. The result is three almost identical resumes that center around specific technical

skills and key phrases. It is difficult to understand how resumes are supposed to convey individuality and unique experience when the AI is only looking for specific words that every candidate is likely to include. The only answer lies in your experience and in your voice. Assuming that every applicant uses AI to tailor their resumes, it renders the skills section obsolete. Every application that passes the AI screening will have to have the necessary keywords. It is important to include those keywords to get past the AI, but to land an interview, your authenticity must still be able to be interpreted by the hiring manager. Showcase specific projects, classes, or experiences that give you the ability to perform the job required. In a world where every resume is exactly the same, genuine interest and human experience are more valuable than ever.

Conclusion

As we enter a fundamentally new employment era, new graduates and experienced hires alike are struggling to adapt to a rapidly changing environment. The unstable nature of the job market combined with a booming AI industry has upended employment as we know it. AI will only continue to infiltrate our daily lives as it becomes more democratized and adaptable. As it continues to evolve, the job market may continue to shrink as fewer people decide to enter the corporate world. Artificially generated resumes, robot hiring managers, and the lack of human authenticity may tempt candidates to turn away from the job industry entirely. However, AI cannot be ignored. It will continue to learn and improve regardless of public debate. To survive in this environment, it is imperative that candidates adopt adaptability and informed strategy. Learn the algorithm, play by the rules, and stay up to date. To understand AI is to stay ahead of it. In times of immense cultural and technological shift, both employers and job seekers must get ahead, or get left behind.

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